

India, in numbers

The market case for your board and your bank. Sources and dates are given; nothing here is opinion.

01 THE MARKET

Growth. India is the fastest-growing major beverage alcohol market in the world (+7% in H1 2025, IWSR).

Scale. On course to be the world's fifth-largest alcohol market by 2031, behind China, the US, Brazil and Mexico.

The consumer. The world's largest whisky market is premiumising: urban 25-to-40 buyers trade up, cocktail culture is expanding, and women are a fast-growing consumer group.

The season. The October-to-December festive quarter, led by Diwali gifting, carries an outsized share of premium spirits sales. Launch calendars are built around it.

The corridor. India-Mexico trade reached USD 11.7 billion in 2024, an all-time high (Embassy of India figures).

02 THE CATEGORY

Tequila. India's fastest-growing spirit: roughly 31% a year, and the category has tripled in four years.

The shelf. Only two or three imported tequila brands hold meaningful national presence. Craft 100% agave has no champion; mezcal has no organised shelf at all.

The signal. Radico Khaitan, with Shah Rukh Khan and Nikhil Kamath, launched D'YAVOL Anejo at Rs 20,000 to 30,000, bottled in origin. Indian capital believes in the top of this category.

The policy wind. India's treaty with the UK cuts scotch duty from 150% to 75% at entry into force, then to 40% within a decade. Organised corridors get policy outcomes; the Mexico corridor is being organised now.

03 THE MATH

The multiple. An Indian shelf price lands at five to seven times FOB, after duty, state taxes and margins.

The band. The winning consumer price band for imported spirits runs about USD 26 to 79 at retail.

The horizon. Plan 18 to 24 months from first buyer meeting to stable distribution. India rewards patience budgeted like capital.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS PAGE

Use it with your board and your bank. These numbers are the case for the investment the rest of this file set will ask of you.